



Figure 4: Sabayon's GNOME desktop



Figure 5: Spritz package manager

the GNOME Printer Manager. This application was able to configure my printer correctly for a change. However, when I tried to use XSane to test-scan something, it again reported that there was no device found.

I didn't expect Sabayon to have such issues with my hardware, since it included the latest OSS tools. Other distros that utilise the same tools detect and configure these easily.

Considering that Sabayon comes with kernel 2.6.27, which includes drivers for Atheros Wi-Fi chips that supposedly provide advanced support for the latest Wi-Fi routers, I think there shouldn't be any problem using it. I didn't have one. See if you have any issues and do report your experience.

## Ah, all these goodies...

Application availability is an area in which Sabayon really shines. In fact, when it comes to out-of-the-box competition with other distros, Sabayon wins hands down (apart from Knoppix, perhaps). The DVD is 4.13 GB, which pretty much expands to a requirement of more than 12 GB for a full install. So do make sure you have enough space before a full installation. Whether you need an application for your day-to-day activities or some really exquisite feature, it's all pre-loaded! A few of the basic software and core utilities included in the OS are:

| List of applications    |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Software category       | Available applications                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Accessories             | Archive Manager, LXTerminal, Xarchiver, Kworldclock                                                                                                                                                 |
| Games                   | Battle for Wesnoth, Nexuiz, Sau-erbraten, Second Life, KDE and GNOME Games Pack                                                                                                                     |
| Graphics                | DJView, FortForge, F-Spot, The GIMP, Gpic View, Hugin Panaro-ma Creator, Inkscape, OpenOf-fice.org Draw, X-Scane, Kooka, Kfax                                                                       |
| Internet                | aLink Creator, aMSN, aMule, Deluge Torrent Client, Ekiga VoIP, Epiphany Browser, Filezilla FTP, Google Earth, Konversation, Logjam, Firefox, NXClient, Pidgin, Seamonkey, Skype VoIP, Wxcas, Zenmap |
| Office and productivity | Evolution, OpenOffice.org Office Suite                                                                                                                                                              |
| Programming             | Beanshell Prompt, Cmake, Doxy Wizard, Glade Interface, De-signer, iLConstans, Monodoc, Qt Designer, Quanta Plus, KHTML Image Map Editor, Klink Status, KXSLDgb                                      |
| Sound & multimedia      | Ardour2, Audacious, Audacity, DVDrip, Elisa Media Centre, K3b, K9Copy, Lacie Lightscribe Label-ers, Lightscribe Simple Labelers, Totem, Mplayer, SMplayer, TV Time, VLC, Xine                       |
| Education               | KDE education package                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Systems tools           | ATI Control Centre, Avahi Ze-roconf browser, Bluetooth File Sharing, CUPS Utils, HP Device Manager, Nvidia Control Centre, Virtual Box, VrtManager, Wine-Doors, Wireshark                           |

Table 1

1. KDE 3.5.10
2. GNOME 2.24.2
3. The GIMP 2.6.2
4. K3b 1.0.5
5. Ekiga 2.0.12
6. OpenOffice.org 3.0.0
7. Firefox 3.0.4
8. Skype

Refer to Table 1 for a list of some of the available applications.

The application versions are pretty much up-to-date. However, one thing to note here is that it includes a poorly-configured GIMP. The present version mimics the window management behaviour of the older version 2.4, and even editing the settings from *Preference-->Windows Management* didn't restore the original window behaviour.